

Ἄτταλος ὁ Ῥόδιος

Aratus Revisited Through Attalus of Rhodes

eul_aid: meo

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Ἐπιστήμη [Science](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Attalus of Rhodes was a Greek astronomer and mathematician active in the mid-2nd century BCE. He is known for his commentary on the astronomical poem **Phaenomena** by Aratus of Soli. His life details are unrecorded, but his work is discussed in relation to the later astronomer Hipparchus of Nicaea.

His only known work is a **Commentary on Aratus's Phaenomena**, which survives only in fragments. These are preserved primarily through references and criticisms in the extant commentary on Aratus written by Hipparchus. Attalus is significant for his early scholarly engagement with Aratus's popularization of Eudoxan astronomy.

His commentary represents a Hellenistic effort to interpret these celestial models, and his interpretations were later scrutinized by Hipparchus. Hipparchus's critiques provide the main evidence for Attalus's astronomical views, placing him within the period's technical scientific discourse.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα Ἄρατου · [Fragments of Aratus](#) · 30 passages